10.3.2 Symptoms

The symptoms of nephritis are:

- Haematuria (blood in the urine)
- Proteinuria (protein the urine)
- Oedema (fluid retention)
- Shortness of breath
- Tachycardia (increased heartbeat)
- Elevated blood pressure
- Anorexia
- Oliguria (low excretion of urine) /anuria (no excretion of urine)
- Uraemia (increased serum urea)



Activity : 1

Write the normal values of the following:

1. Blood Urea Men: ---------- mg/dl
2. Women: ----------mg/dl
3. Serum creatinine Men: ---------- mg/dl
4. Women: ----------mg/dl
5. Serum Uric acid Men: ---------- mg/
   Women: ---------- mg/dl

10.3.3. Dietary management

Objectives

- Reduce elevated serum nitrogen levels from breakdown of exogenous or endogenous proteins.
- Reduce elevated blood pressure or oedema.
- Spare protein for tissue repair.
- Improve renal functioning.
- In children, avoid growth retardation over time.

The dietary management provides optimal nutrition support. Adequate proteins should be given, unless there is oliguria or anuria. Salt is restricted if there is oedema, hypertension or oliguria.

Energy: 80kcal/ kg body weight and 10 percent for infection is suggested. Sufficient calories are given without increasing the protein intake by means of sugar, honey, glucose, sago and other starchy foods like arrowroot. Above mentioned foods are not only rich in calories but also poor in protein, sodium and potassium.

Protein: Usually the diet contains 0.5 grams of protein/kg of ideal body weight. The intake of protein is reduced to a minimum by excluding protein rich foods. A low protein diet is recommended so as to give rest to the kidneys. Complete proteins like milk, fish, etc are better to ensure maximum utilization. Second quality proteins like pulses are restricted. Rice is preferable as it has low amount of protein but better quality of protein than wheat.

Fluids: Daily fluid replacement should be 500ml plus daily amount excreted in urine. The fluid is calculated taking into account the water consumed with drugs, water present in milk, curds, buttermilk, tea, coffee, fruit juice and water used in sambhar and rasam.

Sodium: The sodium is restricted to 500 to 1000mg/day. In sodium restricted diets, the following foods are avoided:

- Salt during cooking or on the table.
- Baked products containing baking soda and sodium bicarbonate.
- Papads
- Pickles
- Salted chips
- Salted nuts
- Foods where sodium salts are used as a preservative like squashes and sauces.
- Dried fruits
- Dried fish.

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